TWELVE PRIVATE VILLAS · JUBILEE HILLS

BY SSQUARE · HYDERABAD

# Croft

*Private land. Personal standard.*

Brand Identity Presentation
Confidential

## The smallest legally recognised unit of private land in Britain.

In Scotland, a croft is not owned — it is held. The crofter occupies by right, by inheritance, by continuity. The land cannot be seized, cannot be reassigned, cannot be developed without the crofter's consent. Crofting legislation (1886) was the first time in British history that the state acknowledged that a family's relationship to a specific piece of land had a value beyond its market price.

The word itself is Old English: croft, from Proto-Germanic kruftan — an enclosed field, a private holding. It gives us "crypt" (enclosed, protected space) and "grotto" (the same root, via Latin). A croft is not a house. It is the land that makes the house permanent.

# *The Arts & Crafts Lineage*

1880 – PRESENT · THREE PEOPLE, ONE ARGUMENT

WILLIAM MORRIS · 1834–1896

*The joy of labour made visible in the object*

Morris argued that industrial production destroyed the worker and debased the object simultaneously. Against the factory, he proposed the workshop — a place where the person who made a thing was also the person who understood it. At Croft: every surface has a reason. The visible joinery is visible because it should be. The material is named because it matters.

EDWIN LUTYENS · 1869–1944

*A building that looks as if it was always there*

Lutyens built country houses that appeared organic to their sites — low, generous in eave, thick-walled, rooted in the soil. He used local stone where possible and designed gardens (with Gertrude Jekyll) that looked as if nature had done it. His buildings did not announce themselves. They settled. Croft inherits his approach to site: the land tells the building where to be.

GERTRUDE JEKYLL · 1843–1932

*The garden as an argument against symmetry*

Jekyll's gardens were anti-formal — not in the sense of being casual, but in the sense of being responsive. She planted by colour, season, and behaviour, not by geometric plan. The border grew in a drift, not a line. Croft landscapes with species native to the Deccan plateau — not imported ornamentals, but plants that have been growing in this soil without maintenance for decades.

THE COUNTRY HOUSE HOTEL · 1970S–PRESENT

*Private estate logic, made liveable for strangers*

Babington House. Soho Farmhouse. Calcot Manor. These hotels work because they operate on croft logic — a specific piece of land, made by people who understood it, managed as if the next generation will inherit it. They feel lived-in because they are. Croft applies the same logic to permanent residence: not a hotel that feels like home, but a home that has a hotel's material rigour.

PAUL SMITH · 1946–PRESENT

*The intelligent layering of things collected over time*

Paul Smith's shops — and his house — are the product of forty years of collecting: the unexpected next to the expected, the vintage next to the new, every object with a story. Croft does not furnish — it creates the conditions for furnishing. The architecture is open enough for a family to make it theirs, specific enough to set the register.

NATIONAL TRUST · 1895–PRESENT

*The principle that some land is too important to be privately optimised*

The National Trust holds land not as investment but as custodianship. Croft is not a public trust — it is a private holding of twelve families. But it applies the same principle: the land at Prashashan Nagar is too good, too particular, to be built to a market brief. The twelve villas are not the maximum that could have been built here. They are the right number.

# Twelve holdings. Each one its own private standard.

XII
PRIVATE VILLAS

PRASHASHAN NAGAR · JUBILEE HILLS · HYDERABAD

# *The neighbourhood that has never been a postcode. It has always been a piece of ground.*

Prashashan Nagar is Jubilee Hills at its most essential. No through traffic, no commercial strip, no shortcut to anywhere. The canopy grew in over four decades without a landscape architect — which is exactly why it looks the way it does. The families who have been here longest stopped thinking about the address in the 1990s. It is the part of the city that had no reason to change and so simply didn't. Croft occupies a specific piece of this ground: twelve plots, surrounded by the same mature trees that were here before the tech city was built. Ten minutes from HITEC City in distance. A different chapter of the city's character entirely.

**10'**
From HITEC City by car

**0**
Through traffic in the street

**40yr**
Established canopy. Undisturbed.

**XII**
Holdings behind one gate.

THE DEVELOPER

# SSquare Est. 1991

Thirty-five years in Hyderabad commercial real estate. Over ten million square feet — privately held, privately financed. SSquare has never entered the residential market and never intended to. Croft is the exception: a decision made not from strategy but from the conviction that this particular piece of land, in this particular neighbourhood, deserved to be built with the same rigour SSquare has applied to three decades of commercial projects.

Twelve villas. The right number. Not the maximum the land could support — the right number for a community that will actually know each other.

**35**

Years building Hyderabad's commercial infrastructure

**10M+**

Square feet of premium commercial real estate

**01**

Residential project. This is their only one.

*"The Standard, Privately Held."*

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